DRAFT

Sandbags for Home Runoff

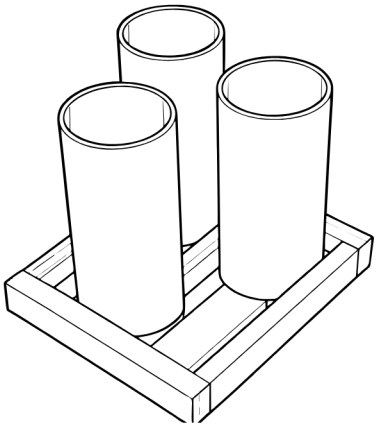
Use a multi-bag filling fixture to hold bags open, fill them evenly, and clear the work area for the next batch.

△ **CAUTION — PREVENT HARM**

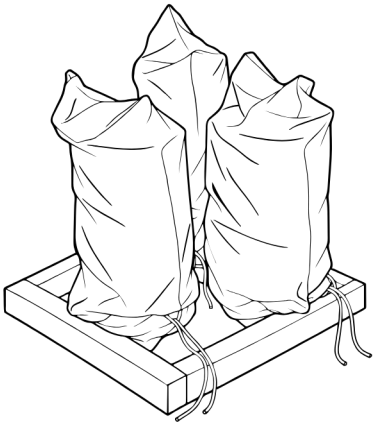
Work on level, dry ground. Wear gloves and sturdy shoes; use eye protection when sand is dusty. A filled bag may weigh 35–40 lb—use a partner or lighter bags if needed.

FILL SANDBAGS WITH THE FIXTURE

1. **Invert the fixture.**
2. **Put a sandbag on each pipe.** Pull each bag far enough over its pipe to keep it in place.

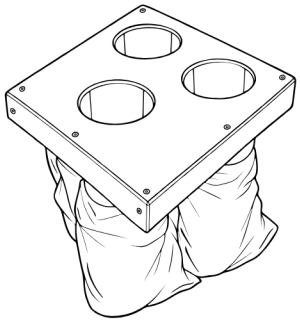


1. Invert the fixture.

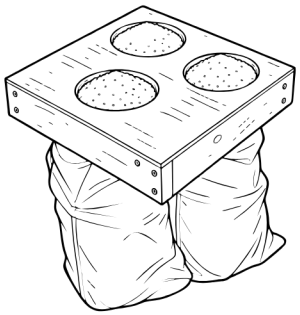


2. Put a sandbag on each pipe.

3. **Turn the fixture right side up.**
4. **Fill to the top with sand.** Keep the fill even among the three openings.



3. Turn the fixture right side up.



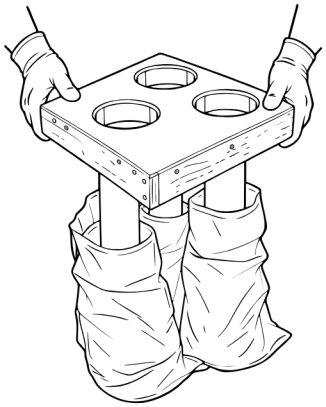
4. Fill to the top with sand.

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Sandbags for Home Runoff — continued

Lift the fixture straight up, reset it for the next batch, and move completed bags clear.

5. **Lift the fixture and allow the sand to remain behind in the bags.** Use a partner and lift together.



5. Lift the fixture. Let the filled bags remain on the ground.



6. Set the fixture upside down. Prepare for more sandbags.



7. Move the sandbags away. Keep the work area clear.

6. **Set the fixture upside down to prepare for more sandbags.**
7. **Move the sandbags away from the work area.** Flatten the sand toward the closed end; leave enough empty bag to fold underneath during placement.

Sandbags for Home Runoff — continued

Use a short, low row to steer shallow runoff or pooling away from a vulnerable opening.

× DANGER — STOP NOW

Leave the area if water is moving fast, rising around you, or cutting off your exit. Do not enter flowing water or build beside an unstable slope or wall.

1. PICK THE ROUTE

Find where water arrives and a safe outlet. Set bags on firm ground **uphill of the opening**. Lead water to an existing drain path on your property—never toward a neighbor, road, or another doorway. Keep drains and your exit open; watch for pooling behind the line.

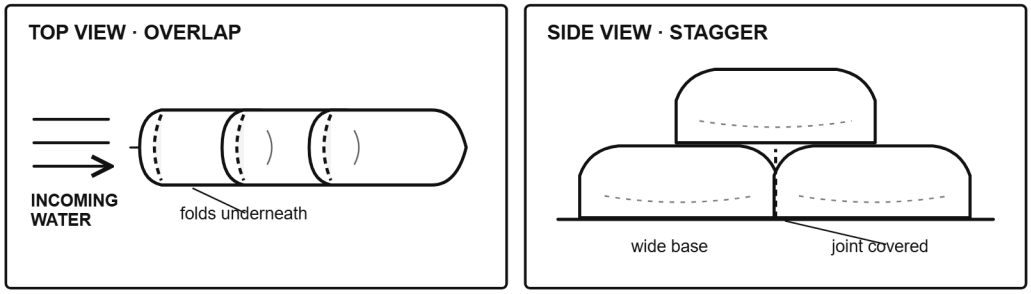


Use staggered sandbags to guide water towards an outlet. For stopping water, create a pyramidal berm.

Sandbags for Home Runoff — continued

2. LAY A LOW, TIGHT LINE

1. Clear loose debris and fill low spots first. Keep the line short, low, and away from a building wall.
2. Lay bags flat, **folded end underneath and toward incoming water**. Lap the filled part over the previous bag's empty end; press them together. Walk on the sandbags to lock them in place.
3. For a second layer, cover joints below. Widen the base as height increases; avoid a tall, narrow wall.



Top and side views. Overlap the tails; stagger joints and widen the base.
Original Fire Watch diagram, after USACE §2.3.

Recheck from safe ground: check for water around the ends, through gaps, or pooling behind the line. Bags redirect shallow water but do not form a watertight seal. Leave if conditions worsen.

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Sandbags for Home Runoff — continued

SOURCES

RiverOakRanch, “Filling Sandbags the Easy Way, With Sandbag Tubes” (2010): www.instructables.com/Filling-Sandbags-the-Easy-way-with-Sandbag-Tubes/. Accessed 2026-09-24.

SOURCES

U.S. Army Corps of Engineers, *Flood Fight Handbook* (2022), §2.1–2.3: www.mvp.usace.army.mil/Portals/57/MVP%20Flood%20Fight%20Handbook%202022.pdf. RiverOakRanch, “Filling Sandbags the Easy Way, With Sandbag Tubes” (2010): www.instructables.com/Filling-Sandbags-the-Easy-way-with-Sandbag-Tubes/. Accessed 2026-09-24.

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USACE, *Flood Fight Handbook* (2022), §2.2–2.3: www.mvp.usace.army.mil/Portals/57/MVP%20Flood%20Fight%20Handbook%202022.pdf.